

CSS Cheatsheet

Basics

Features for styling with CSS.

Feature	Uses	Example	Explanation	Practical Uses
Selector	Selects elements to style.	<code>p { color: red; }</code>	Applies styles to all <code><p></code> tags.	Changing default look of elements.
Class Selector	Targets elements with class.	<code>.btn { background: blue; }</code>	Styles elements with <code>class="btn"</code> .	Reusable button styles.
ID Selector	Targets element by ID.	<code>#header { font-size: 20px; }</code>	Styles unique element with <code>id="header"</code> .	Specific unique section.
Inline Style	Direct style in element.	<code><p style="color:green;"></code>	Overrides stylesheet but not reusable.	Quick one-off fixes.
Universal Selector	Styles all elements.	<code>* { margin: 0; }</code>	Affects everything on page.	Reset default spacing.

Colors & Backgrounds

Feature	Uses	Example	Explanation	Practical Uses
Color	Sets text color.	<code>p { color: blue; }</code>	Changes text color.	Branding, emphasis.
Background Color	Sets element background.	<code>div { background: yellow; }</code>	Fills element box with color.	Section highlights.
Background Image	Sets image as background.	<code>div { background-image: url(bg.jpg); }</code>	Applies image inside box.	Hero sections, banners.
Gradient	Smooth color transition.	<code>background: linear-gradient(red, blue);</code>	Creates gradient background.	Buttons, modern designs.
Opacity	Adjusts transparency.	<code>div { opacity: 0.5; }</code>	Makes element semi-transparent.	Overlays, fades.

Typography

Feature	Uses	Example	Explanation	Practical Uses
Font Family	Sets typeface.	<code>p { font-family: Arial, sans-serif; }</code>	Defines font style.	Branding text.
Font Size	Sets text size.	<code>p { font-size: 18px; }</code>	Controls readability.	Headings, body text.
Font Weight	Boldness of text.	<code>p { font-weight: bold; }</code>	Makes text thicker.	Emphasis.
Text Align	Aligns text horizontally.	<code>p { text-align: center; }</code>	Left, right, center, justify.	Centered headings.
Line Height	Controls spacing between lines.	<code>p { line-height: 1.6; }</code>	Improves readability.	Paragraph styling.

Box Model

Feature	Uses	Example	Explanation	Practical Uses
Margin	Space outside element.	<code>div { margin: 20px; }</code>	Creates outer spacing.	Layout spacing.
Padding	Space inside element.	<code>div { padding: 10px; }</code>	Inner spacing around content.	Button padding.
Border	Outline of element.	<code>div { border: 2px solid black; }</code>	Adds border around box.	Input fields.
Width/Height	Sets element size.	<code>div { width: 200px; height: 100px; }</code>	Fixes element dimensions.	Containers.
Box Sizing	Defines how size is calculated.	<code>div { box-sizing: border-box; }</code>	Includes padding/border in total size.	Consistent layouts.

Positioning & Layout

Feature	Uses	Example	Explanation	Practical Uses
Display	Sets element display type.	<code>div { display: flex; }</code>	Options: block, inline, flex, grid.	Layout design.

Feature	Uses	Example	Explanation	Practical Uses
Position	Controls placement.	<code>div { position: absolute; top: 10px; }</code>	Static, relative, absolute, fixed, sticky.	Navbars, modals.
Z-Index	Layer order.	<code>div { z-index: 10; }</code>	Higher values appear above others.	Modals, overlays.
Float	Moves element left/right.	<code>img { float: right; }</code>	Old layout method, still useful.	Wrapping text around images.
Clear	Controls float wrapping.	<code>p { clear: both; }</code>	Prevents overlap after floated elements.	Fixing layout issues.

Flexbox

Feature	Uses	Example	Explanation	Practical Uses
Display Flex	Activates flexbox.	<code>div { display: flex; }</code>	Enables flex container.	Navbars, grids.
Justify Content	Align items horizontally.	<code>justify-content: space-between;</code>	Start, end, center, space-around, etc.	Navigation menus.
Align Items	Align vertically.	<code>align-items: center;</code>	Aligns children inside container.	Centered layouts.
Flex Wrap	Controls wrapping.	<code>flex-wrap: wrap;</code>	Items move to next line if needed.	Responsive grids.
Flex Grow	Allows items to expand.	<code>flex: 1;</code>	Divides available space.	Equal-width cards.

Grid

Feature	Uses	Example	Explanation	Practical Uses
Display Grid	Enables grid layout.	<code>div { display: grid; }</code>	Turns element into grid container.	Dashboards, galleries.
Grid Template Columns	Defines columns.	<code>grid-template-columns: repeat(3, 1fr);</code>	Creates 3 equal columns.	Layout sections.

Feature	Uses	Example	Explanation	Practical Uses
Grid Gap	Spacing between items.	<code>gap: 20px;</code>	Space between rows/columns.	Clean layouts.
Grid Row/Col Span	Spans multiple cells.	<code>grid-column: span 2;</code>	Expands item across columns.	Wide cards.
Place Items	Shorthand for align & justify.	<code>place-items: center;</code>	Centers content in both directions.	Centered widgets.

Transitions & Animations

Feature	Uses	Example	Explanation	Practical Uses
Transition	Smooth property changes.	<code>transition: all 0.3s ease;</code>	Animates changes.	Button hover effects.
Transform	Rotate, scale, skew.	<code>transform: rotate(45deg);</code>	Changes element visually.	Rotating icons.
Animation	Defines keyframes.	<code>animation: bounce 2s infinite;</code>	Creates continuous effects.	Loaders, banners.
Keyframes	Define animation steps.	<code>@keyframes bounce { from {top:0;} to {top:10px;} }</code>	Sets animation motion.	Custom animations.
Hover/Focus	Pseudo-classes.	<code>button:hover { background: red; }</code>	Adds interactivity.	Links, buttons.